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**Joby Aviation doubles
pilot eVTOL facility
capacity as it races to
launch air taxis**

Joby Aviation has doubled the size and production capacity of its pilot manufacturing facility in Marina, California, as it races to commercialize eVTOLs (electric vertical takeoff and landing vehicles) by early next year.

The now-435,500-square-foot facility will be able to produce 24 aircraft per year, and “nearly one” every other week once fully operational, according to Joby. The facility will also support regional training and aircraft maintenance.

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IMAGE CREDITS: JOBY AVIATION
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TechCrunch has asked when Joby expects to produce vehicles at full capacity, as well as for updates on Joby’s first scaled facility in Dayton, Ohio, which would build up to 500 aircraft per year once it’s constructed.

Joby has enlisted engineers from its investor Toyota to help build both sites. Toyota in May closed the first, \$250 million tranche of a previously announced [\\$500 million investment](#) into Joby.

The news of Joby’s expanded pilot facility comes as the eVTOL company adds a sixth aircraft to its fleet.

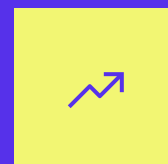
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Joby says the aircraft earned its airworthiness certification within a week of completion.

Joby went public through a [SPAC merger](#) in 2021. The company plans to launch commercial operations first in Dubai in early 2026, and in a U.S. city afterwards.

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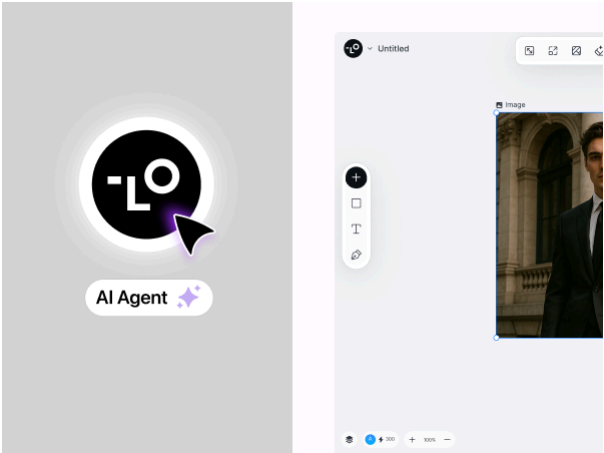
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Joby flies towards 2025 commercial launch with final assembly of eVTOL



Rebecca Bellan — 5:00 AM PST · February 14, 2023

Electric vertical takeoff and landing (eVTOL) company Joby Aviation has taken another step on its path to start a commercial air taxi service by 2025. The company said Tuesday that it's begun final assembly on its "company conforming" eVTOL, which is essentially a prototype that's a couple steps away from the final version.

Joby says it will be submitting the aircraft in the first half of this year.

The technological milestone comes a week after [Joby completed the second stage](#) of a process with the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) to achieve type certification for its aircraft for commercial passenger use. Joby says it's making moves on the final three stages of that process, as well.

Type certification would mean the FAA approves Joby's aircraft design and all component parts. It also signifies the design is compliant with the agency's standards for airworthiness and noise.

After that, Joby will have to build and test the aircraft.

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management system and regular FAA reviews, brings the company closer to receiving its production certification.

Joby has already built the major structures of the aircraft, like the wing, tail and fuselage, and will now fuse everything together and install wiring, electronics, actuation and propulsion systems.

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The aircraft will be the first one produced at Joby's pilot manufacturing facility in Marina, California. That facility is designed to prove out Joby's manufacturing process through low-rate manufacturing and is capable of producing tens of aircraft per year, according to the company. Joby is

already using the facility to build and assemble parts for future aircraft.

When it comes to more scaled manufacturing, Joby is currently in the market for a location for its Phase 1 production facility. The company says it's actively reviewing proposals from a number of states keen to boost manufacturing and create jobs.

Joby Aviation secures certificate to operate commercial air taxis



Joby Aviation — the publicly traded electric air vehicle company with a current market cap of \$3.1 billion — has received the necessary certification from the Federal Aviation Administration to begin on-demand commercial air taxi operations, the company said on Thursday. While it's a significant milestone that puts Joby closer to its stated goal of ... [Continue reading](#)



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Rebecca Bellan

Senior Reporter |

Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, where she covers Tesla and Elon Musk's broader empire,...

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Joby Aviation receives permit to fly first eVTOL built on production line

Rebecca Bellan — 5:00 AM PDT · June 28, 2023



Joby Aviation has reached a series of milestones that put it on track to deliver its first electric aircraft to a customer by 2024 and commercialize an air taxi service by 2025.

IMAGE CREDITS: JOBY AVIATION

Joby's Marina, California pilot production plant, which operates in partnership with Toyota, has rolled out its first eVTOL (electric vertical takeoff and landing vehicle) — made possible by a helpful [\\$180 million injection](#) from investor Baillie Gifford in May. The aircraft is Joby's first production prototype, and it means Joby is one step away from having a commercially viable eVTOL for passenger use.

The production prototype eVTOL — Joby's third full-scale prototype — also received a special airworthiness certificate issued by the Federal

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Aviation Administration (FAA) and can now begin flight testing.

“This first aircraft coming off our pilot manufacturing line is a really, really big deal for the company,” Joe Ben Bevirt, founder and CEO of Joby, told TechCrunch. “We have spent many years building the processes and procedures and capabilities as an organization to be able to deliver this level of aircraft. We’ve been building since 2017, but to be able to build with this level of rigor is a huge step forward. It prepares us for this next stage of the certification process.”

Joby has already flown more than 30,000 miles since 2019 on pre-production prototype aircraft. This latest iteration builds on that experience and puts the company closer to achieving type certification with the FAA. Type certification means that the FAA approves of Joby’s aircraft design and component parts, and that the design is compliant with the agency’s standards for airworthiness and noise.

Joby nearly has three out of the five necessary stages of the type certification process underway, according to Bevirt. The final step after type certification would be production certification, which will allow Joby to mass produce eVTOLs under FAA-approved designs.

The eVTOL company already received its [Part 135 air carrier certificate](#), which allows Joby to begin on-demand commercial air taxi operations, in May 2022.

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Joby's production prototype aircraft has the potential to be the first eVTOL delivered to a customer, says the company. It will be deployed at Edwards Air Force Base in 2024, per [Joby's Agility Prime contract](#) with the U.S. Air Force, which is worth up to \$131 million. To meet that deadline, Joby will have to work quickly with the Air Force in order to secure military airworthiness certification.

The design of that aircraft will be replicated at Joby's pilot manufacturing facility.

"We have multiple of these aircraft coming down the production line, and that will be what we'll be using both for customer applications and also for the type certification process," said Bevirt.

Joby plans to commercialize an aerial rideshare service by 2025.

A deepening relationship with Toyota

Joby's pilot manufacturing line was built in partnership with Toyota. The Japanese automaker is Joby's largest external investor and will supply powertrains and actuation components to the company.

“Not only has Toyota invested almost \$400 million in the company, they’ve also put a significant number of engineers on site with us working shoulder to shoulder here in California, as well as having a team of engineers back in Japan working on processes,” said Bevirt. “So when people come through our pilot manufacturing line, they can see the incredible technologies and systems that Toyota has brought to bear and help Joby learn about how to do manufacturing.”

The pilot manufacturing line gives Joby the capability to make tens of aircraft per year, said Bevirt. The next stage is building a “phase one manufacturing facility” that will allow Joby to build larger quantities of eVTOL. Bevirt didn’t say where that manufacturing facility would be or when Joby hopes to break ground, but he did say the partnership with Toyota would be essential for that project, too.

In a move that deepens the relationship between the two companies, Joby also announced Wednesday that Tetsuo “Ted” Ogawa, president and CEO of Toyota Motor North America, will join Joby’s board of directors on July 1.

Ogawa has 39 years of experience at Toyota and currently leads Toyota North America as president and CEO, which runs 14 production plants in North America.

“As we look at scaling our manufacturing, we couldn’t be more thrilled to have somebody of his stature joining the Joby board,” said Bevirt. “We think this really demonstrates Toyota’s commitment to leading in this next stage of mobility.”

Aside from a manufacturer-investor relationship, Joby has worked with [Toyota and Japanese airline ANA](#) to explore ways to launch an air taxi service in

Japan that connects to ground-based transportation.

Bevirt wouldn't say where Joby intends to commercialize air taxi operations first, but he did say that the company has been working closely with the Japan Civil Aviation Bureau, which Bevirt describes as "extremely forward leaning."

"We'll be continuing to engage with them on our path to bringing the service to Japan," he said.

Topics: [eVTOL](#) [Joby Aviation](#) [Transportation](#)

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